

Cause & Effect

Grade 3 Reading Comprehension Worksheet

Read each passage. Then answer the question.

Passage 1

In August, hot dry winds blew across the farm for six weeks and no rain fell. The corn plants turned yellow and drooped. Mr. Bell had to pull up half his crop because it could not grow without water.

1. Why did the corn plants turn yellow and droop?
 - a. The wind blew the seeds away.
 - b. No rain fell for six weeks.
 - c. Mr. Bell pulled up half his crop.

Passage 2

Lena forgot to close her bedroom window on a stormy night. Rain blew in and soaked her library books. In the morning, the pages were wrinkled and the covers were bent.

2. Why were Lena's library books ruined?
 - a. She read them in the bathtub.
 - b. The pages were wrinkled and bent.
 - c. Rain blew in through the open window.

Passage 3

The soccer field was covered with ice after the freezing rain. The coach moved practice inside the gym so no one would slip and get hurt.

3. Why did the coach move practice inside?
 - a. The field was covered with ice.
 - b. The team played in the gym.
 - c. The coach likes the gym better.

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Sam ate three big slices of birthday cake and a whole bowl of ice cream. An hour later his stomach ached, and he had to lie down on the couch.

1. Why did Sam's stomach ache?
 - a. The birthday party was too loud.
 - b. He ate too much cake and ice cream.
 - c. He lay down on the couch.

Passage 2

A strong wind knocked over the trash cans on our street. Papers and cans blew all over the sidewalk. Dad and I spent an hour picking everything up.

2. Why was trash all over the sidewalk?
 - a. Dad and I picked everything up.
 - b. The garbage truck came early.
 - c. A strong wind knocked over the trash cans.

Passage 3

Nina left her bike out in the rain all weekend. By Monday the chain was covered in orange rust and would not turn.

3. Why was Nina's bike chain rusty?
 - a. She left the bike out in the rain.
 - b. The chain would not turn.
 - c. She rode it through mud.

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The classroom hamster knocked its water bottle off the cage. Water poured onto the desk and soaked Mia's spelling homework.

1. Why was Mia's homework soaked?
 - a. The desk was wet.
 - b. Mia spilled her juice.
 - c. The hamster knocked over its water bottle.

Passage 2

Dark clouds covered the sky and thunder rumbled. Mom called the children inside because lightning is dangerous.

2. Why did Mom call the children inside?
 - a. It was time for dinner.
 - b. A thunderstorm with lightning was coming.
 - c. The children were playing outside.

Passage 3

Tom watered his bean plant every day and put it in the sunny window. In two weeks it grew tall with bright green leaves.

3. Why did Tom's bean plant grow tall?
 - a. He watered it and gave it sunlight.
 - b. He sang songs to it.
 - c. The leaves were bright green.

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Passage 1

The power went out during the storm. Without lights, the family ate dinner by candlelight and told stories.

1. Why did the family eat by candlelight?
 - a. The power went out in the storm.
 - b. They told stories at dinner.
 - c. The candles were new.

Passage 2

Ants found the cookie crumbs under the picnic table. Soon a long line of ants marched across the blanket to carry the crumbs home.

2. Why did ants march across the blanket?
 - a. The blanket was on the grass.
 - b. They found cookie crumbs to carry home.
 - c. The children were eating cookies.

Passage 3

Ben stayed up past midnight reading his new book. The next morning he could hardly keep his eyes open in class.

3. Why was Ben sleepy in class?
 - a. He stayed up past midnight reading.
 - b. His eyes felt heavy.
 - c. The classroom was warm.

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Passage 1

The dog dug a deep hole under the fence and squeezed through. It ran to the park, where the owner found it chasing squirrels.

1. Why did the dog get out of the yard?
 - a. It dug a hole under the fence.
 - b. It chased squirrels in the park.
 - c. The gate was painted red.

Passage 2

Ice formed on the pond overnight. In the morning, ducks slid across the ice instead of swimming.

2. Why did the ducks slide instead of swim?
 - a. It was morning.
 - b. The ducks were playing.
 - c. The pond froze overnight.

Passage 3

Sara practiced the piano for thirty minutes every day. At the recital, she played her song without a single mistake.

3. Why did Sara play without mistakes?
 - a. She practiced every day.
 - b. Her piano is new.
 - c. The recital was in the evening.

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Passage 1

The library was too noisy because workers were fixing the roof. Mrs. Lee moved story time to the quiet garden outside.

1. Why did Mrs. Lee move story time outside?
 - a. The garden was quiet.
 - b. It was a sunny day.
 - c. The library was too noisy from roof work.

Passage 2

Leo ate his sandwich too fast at lunch and started to hiccup. He drank a glass of water slowly until the hiccups stopped.

2. Why did Leo get the hiccups?
 - a. He drank a glass of water.
 - b. His lunch was cold.
 - c. He ate his sandwich too fast.

Passage 3

Heavy rain filled the creek until it spilled over its banks. Water covered the low bridge, so cars had to take another road.

3. Why did cars take another road?
 - a. The creek spilled over its banks.
 - b. The bridge was painted last year.
 - c. Water covered the low bridge.

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Passage 1

The kitten chased a ball of yarn across the room. The yarn unrolled and tangled around the chair legs.

1. Why was yarn tangled around the chair legs?
 - a. The kitten chased the ball of yarn.
 - b. The room was messy.
 - c. The chair legs were wooden.

Passage 2

A cold wind blew through the open door all evening. By bedtime, the living room felt like an icebox.

2. Why was the living room so cold?
 - a. It was bedtime.
 - b. The family wore sweaters.
 - c. Cold wind blew through the open door.

Passage 3

The baby bird fell from its nest during the wind. Its mother stayed close and fed it worms on the ground until it could hop.

3. Why did the mother bird feed her baby on the ground?
 - a. The baby fell from its nest.
 - b. Worms are easy to find.
 - c. The baby could hop.

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Passage 1

Max forgot his umbrella on the bus. When it started to rain, he ran home and arrived soaking wet.

1. Why was Max soaking wet?
 - a. He likes running.
 - b. The bus left early.
 - c. He forgot his umbrella and ran home in the rain.

Passage 2

The baker left the bread in the oven too long. The loaves came out black and hard, and the shop smelled like smoke.

2. Why were the loaves black and hard?
 - a. They were left in the oven too long.
 - b. The baker was tired.
 - c. The shop smelled like smoke.

Passage 3

Snow piled up against the front door overnight. Dad had to shovel a path before anyone could leave the house.

3. Why did Dad shovel a path?
 - a. Snow piled up against the door.
 - b. Dad likes to shovel.
 - c. It was morning.

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Passage 1

The fish tank filter stopped working. Without clean water moving through the tank, the water turned cloudy and green.

1. Why did the fish tank water turn green?
 - a. The tank was too small.
 - b. The filter stopped working.
 - c. The fish were hungry.

Passage 2

Ava talked during the whole movie. The people behind her could not hear the actors, so they moved to different seats.

2. Why did the people move seats?
 - a. The seats were uncomfortable.
 - b. Ava talked during the whole movie.
 - c. The movie was long.

Passage 3

The plant by the window leaned toward the glass. It was reaching for the sunlight that came through the window each morning.

3. Why did the plant lean toward the window?
 - a. Plants like water.
 - b. The window was clean.
 - c. It was reaching for the sunlight.

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Passage 1

Jake left his crayons in the hot car. When he came back, the crayons had melted into colorful puddles.

1. Why did the crayons melt?
 - a. They were left in the hot car.
 - b. They were colorful.
 - c. Jake drew pictures.

Passage 2

The pond dried up in the summer heat. The frogs hopped away to find a wetter place to live.

2. Why did the frogs leave the pond?
 - a. It was summer.
 - b. Frogs like to hop.
 - c. The pond dried up in the heat.

Passage 3

Emma dropped her ice cream cone on the hot sidewalk. It melted into a sticky puddle in less than a minute.

3. Why did the ice cream melt so fast?
 - a. It fell on the hot sidewalk.
 - b. Emma was sad.
 - c. It was a big cone.